Herbs such as **coriander and mint** have a thin and **weak stem. Trees** such as **peepal** and **banyan have very strong and thick stem called trunk.** As trees grow older, their trunks grow wider.

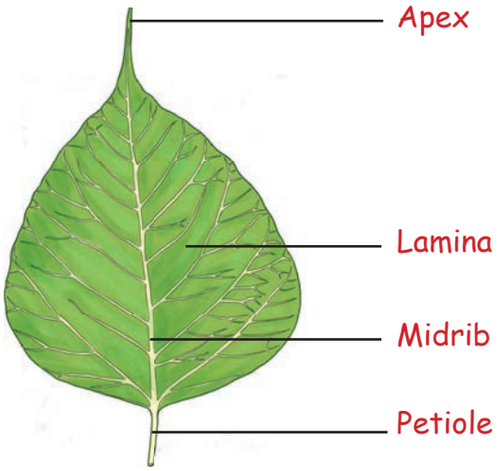
Functions of the Stem



- ❖ It **supports** the whole plant.
- ❖ It **transports** food from leaf and water from root to various parts of the plant.
- ❖ Some stems **store excess food** in them. E.g., Potato, Onion.

Leaves

Leaves originate from the surface of the stem. It is flat, thin and green. Leaves of different plants have different shapes, sizes and colours. Some leaves have even a specific smell.



Functions of Leaf

- ❖ Leaf prepares food for the plant with the help of water, carbon dioxide and in the presence of sunlight and chlorophyll. This process is called photo synthesis. Hence, it is called the food factory of the plant.
- ❖ The loss of water in the form of gas (water vapour) happens through the tiny pores in the leaves. This process is called transpiration. It gives cooling effect to the plant.
- ❖ Leaves of some plants are edible and rich in nutrients. E.g., Greens, Cabbage.

Let us Play

Collect the leaves of coriander, mint, eucalyptus, tamarind, amla, neem and tulsi.



Select two students and cover their eyes with a handkerchief. Give one leaf to each of them. and ask them to identify the leaf by touching or and the other by smelling it. Find out who identifies more leaves.

Which method is easier to identify?

Touching or smelling? ---------- .